06-08 第1篇

阅读理解（说明文） Why Do Cats Purr?

Most cat owners know the soft, low sound a cat makes when it sits on your knee: purring. But why do cats purr? Scientists have been studying this for many years, and the answer is surprisingly complex.

First, we need to understand how purring is made. A cat purrs using special muscles in its throat. These muscles open and close about **25 to 150 times every second**. As air moves in and out, the muscles cause a low sound — this is the purr. Unlike a meow, a purr can continue while the cat breathes in **and** out, so it sounds almost non-stop.

Many people believe that a cat purrs only when it is happy. This is partly true. A healthy cat lying in the sunlight often purrs because it feels safe and warm. But scientists have found that cats also purr when they are worried, hungry or even badly hurt. A cat at the animal hospital may purr while the doctor checks its leg. So purring is not always a sign of joy.

Then why purr when in pain? Some scientists believe the answer lies in the sound's special frequency. The low shaking of a purr, around **25 — 50 Hertz**, seems to help the cat's bones and muscles heal faster. In other words, a cat may be using its own purr as a kind of medicine. This may also explain why cats often get well quickly after small injuries.

Interestingly, purring may help humans too. A few small studies show that people who spend time with a purring cat have a slightly lower heart rate and feel less stress. Of course, this does not mean a cat can cure any disease. But sitting beside a purring cat after a hard school day is, for many people, a small gift of peace.

So next time your cat jumps on your book and starts to purr, remember: that soft sound is more than "I'm happy". It is one of nature's most quiet — and most clever — tools.

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. How does a cat make the purring sound?

A. By shaking its tail quickly.
B. By using special muscles in its throat that open and close many times per second.
C. By hitting its teeth together.
D. By breathing very slowly.

2. According to paragraph 3, a cat may purr when it is _____.

A. only happy
B. only angry
C. happy, worried, hungry or hurt
D. asleep and dreaming

3. Why might purring help a cat when it is hurt?

A. Because the sound makes other cats come and help.
B. Because the low frequency of the purr may help bones and muscles heal.
C. Because the sound frightens the doctor.
D. Because purring makes the cat forget about food.

4. What does the text say about humans and purring cats?

A. Purring cats can cure any disease.
B. People near a purring cat may feel a little less stress.
C. Purring cats always make people sleepy.
D. People who hear a purr cannot concentrate on study.

5. What is the main idea of the passage?

A. Cats and dogs are very different animals.
B. Purring is a simple sign that a cat wants food.
C. Purring has many possible reasons and may even help with healing.
D. Cats purr only when they are young.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第 2 段 "A cat purrs using special muscles in its throat."
【解析】通过喉部肌肉每秒开合 25–150 次发声。A/C/D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第 3 段 "cats also purr when they are worried, hungry or even badly hurt"
【解析】开心、担心、饥饿或受伤都可能发出呼噜声。A/B/D 以偏概全。故选 C。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第 4 段 "around 25 — 50 Hertz, seems to help the cat's bones and muscles heal

faster"
【解析】低频率可能加速骨骼肌肉恢复。A/C/D 均与原文无关。故选 B。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第 5 段 "a slightly lower heart rate and feel less stress"
【解析】靠近呼噜的猫，人会轻微缓解压力。A 过度夸大；C/D 无依据。故选 B。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】全文尤其首尾
【解析】文章说明猫呼噜原因多样且可能助愈合。A/B/D 均不全面或错误。故选 C。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **purr** [v./n.] 发出呼噜声；呼噜声
- **frequency** [n.] 频率
- **Hertz** [n.] 赫兹
- **heal** [v.] 愈合
- **stress** [n.] 压力